Big reactions

One moment. A few words. Enough for today.

AUTISM PATHWAYS CONSULTING

Start with what you noticed

Choose one recent moment. Fill in any one box first.
Skip anything you do not know. You can stop whenever you need.

If things are difficult right now, focus on safety and support first.

Type or write. For typing: download, open in a PDF reader, then save a copy.

01

BEFORE | What was happening?

An activity, a change, waiting, or a request. What did you notice?

02

DURING | What did your child say or do?

Write what you saw or heard. You do not need to explain why.

03

AFTER | What happened next?

What did adults do? What support was offered? How did it end?

Optional clues

Select only what you noticed. Clues are not causes.

☐ Noise ☐ Pace ☐ Tiredness ☐ Discomfort ☐ Not sure

→ *When you are ready, turn the page to choose one small next step.*

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One small next step

Use your notes to choose one adult or environment adjustment.
You do not need to know why the reaction happened.

A FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

Notice: We were rushing to leave. My child said, “Not yet.”

Try: I allow five extra minutes. “Would you like a pause?”

If they decline, I stop pressing and offer space if wanted.

Look for: what they communicate about comfort and readiness.

1 What did I notice?

A brief observation from your notes. “Not sure yet” is a useful answer.

2 What could I change next time?

Choose one: allow more time, offer a quieter place, or simplify what you say.

3 What will I look for?

Notice comfort and communication. Include your child’s own view where possible.

Come back after one similar moment

What changed? What did your child communicate? Keep, adapt or pause the adjustment.

Keep support available

Keep usual communication supports, including AAC, available. Respect “no” or pause signals. If distress increases, stop and prioritise safety. Seek qualified help for pain, sudden change, repeated distress or safety concerns. For immediate danger, use local emergency help.

One comparison cannot confirm a cause. You do not need to record every reaction.
Keep typed notes brief; check all text after saving and before printing.

General guidance: NICE CG170 §1.4 • NJC Communication Bill of Rights

Keep these notes private. You do not need to send them to APC.

For reflection, not diagnosis or an individual support plan.

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APC works with you, not instead of the therapists your child is already seeing.